COMP396 Weekly Meeting Minutes

(Week 10)

Date & Time: Wednesday, November 26th, 2025, 17:00-19:00 (pre-presentation) & Thursday, November 27th, 2025, 17:00-19:00 (post-presentation)

Location: Harold Cohen Library / Lower Ground Group Study Table 2

Note Taker: Zhao Saria

Attendees: Zhang Olivia, Zhao Saria, Xue Yudan, Wong Haw

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1. Agenda:

Wednesday (Pre-Presentation Preparation):

- Familiarize each member with their PPT sections and conduct full presentation rehearsals to synchronize our verbatim scripts with the slides.
- Prepare for potential questions from the examiners by reviewing all report charts and ensuring everyone is familiar with the entire report content.

Thursday (Post-Presentation Review):

- Summarize the feedback provided by the Supervisor and Second Marker after the formal presentation.
- Reflect on the presentation experience and plan the strategy adjustments for Data 2 based on the feedback.

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2. Discussion & Decisions:

2.1. Pre-Presentation Rehearsal (Wednesday)

- **Script & Slide Synchronization:** We focused on integrating our verbatim presentation scripts with the PPT slides. Through multiple mock rounds, we refined our scripts to ensure smooth transitions and perfect alignment with each slide page. We modified our scripts in real-time based on the actual timing to fit the allocated slots.
- **Q&A Readiness:** Following the Supervisor's earlier advice that "everyone should be familiar with all members' work," we reviewed every chart in the Design Report and familiarized ourselves with sections outside our primary responsibilities to ensure comprehensive understanding.

2.2. Post-Presentation Feedback Summary (Thursday)

We successfully completed the formal presentation. The debrief meeting focused on analyzing the critical feedback received from the Supervisor and Second Marker:

- **1. Data Analysis Rigor (Second Marker's Feedback):**
  - *Critique:* All chart analysis must be derived from professional data analysis tools and rigorous mathematical evidence, not just visual inspection or "eyeballing."
  - *Action:* We committed to the Second Marker that the detailed code for the data analysis section will be uploaded in the next assignment to provide verifiable mathematical backing.
- **2. Strategy Selection (Second Marker's Feedback):**
  - *Critique:* The "Buy and Hold" strategy is viewed more as an investment methodology rather than a statistical trading strategy. It was suggested that we should consider replacing it with a more technical approach for the next dataset.
  - *Action:* We will seriously consider this advice. Upon the release of Data 2, we will evaluate the actual returns of various strategies in the new market conditions. If we identify a technical strategy that offers better performance, we will replace

"Buy and Hold"; otherwise, we will justify its retention based on its performance superiority.

- **3. Parameter Justification (Supervisor's Query):**
  - *Issue:* The Supervisor asked about the rationale behind the rebalancing period for the Combined Strategy. Due to nervousness, Zhao Saria did not perfectly articulate the selection basis during the presentation.
  - *Action:* We realized the importance of explicit justification. Since there are no further presentations, all future reports will provide detailed rationales for every parameter and data choice to prevent any ambiguity for the markers.
- **4. AI Tool Usage (Supervisor's Query):**
  - *Issue:* When asked about chart generation, Zhao Saria honestly stated that suggestions from ChatGPT were referenced.
  - *Action:* To maintain academic integrity and transparency, we decided that any constructive suggestions derived from AI tools in future work will be formally cited in references.

2.3. Future Planning & Next Steps

- **Assessment Criteria Inquiry:** We decided to ask the Supervisor in the next meeting about the specific weight/percentage of this presentation in the overall assessment.
- **Data 2 Strategy Prep:** We will not prepare a static list of indicators. Instead, we will formulate questions to ask the Supervisor regarding which specific indicators (e.g., True PD Ratio, Sharpe Ratio) are considered necessary requirements for the upcoming Data 2 assessment.
- **Next Phase:** Our focus will shift to summarizing the Supervisor's answers and formulating a preliminary strategy selection plan for Data 2, ensuring readiness for immediate action upon its release.

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3. Task Allocation:

We are transitioning from the presentation phase to the Data 2 preparation phase.

ID	Module	Task Description	Owner	Due Date
J1	Feedback Implementation	Organize all feedback points (mathematical rigor, strategy evaluation, parameter justification) into a checklist for the next report.	Wong Haw	Dec. 3
J2	Code Preparation	Refine and comment on the data analysis code used in Part 1 to ensure it is ready for submission/reference in the next assignment as promised.	Zhao Saria (Main), Xue Yudan (Assist)	Dec. 3
J3	Meeting Prep (Supervisor)	Draft questions regarding the presentation's grading weight and the necessary indicators/metrics to focus on for Data 2 strategy selection.	Zhang Olivia	Dec. 3

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4. Current Challenges and Issues

- **Technical Depth:** The feedback highlighted a need for greater technical depth, particularly in strategy selection (considering moving away from simple Buy & Hold) and analysis (relying strictly on math/code). The challenge for Data 2 will be implementing these more complex requirements effectively.

5. Supervisor Question

- **Pending Questions:**
    - What is the specific weighting of this presentation in the overall module grade?
    - Which specific indicators (e.g., True PD Ratio, Sharpe Ratio) are considered necessary requirements for the Data 2 assessment?

6. Next Meeting Arrangement

- **Date & Time:** Wednesday, December 3rd, 2025, 14:00-16:00
- **Location:** Sydney Jones Library / Abercromby Study Room 1
- **Key Agenda Items:**
    - Summarize the Supervisor's responses to our post-presentation queries.
    - Begin formulating the strategy selection framework for Data 2.
    - Review the refined data analysis code (Task J2).